

Python 3 on a Mac

Before you install Python 3 on a Mac, make sure you get permission from the computer's owner. You may also need to ask the owner to provide an admin password during installation.

1 Go to the Python link

Type the address below into your web browser to open the Python website. Click on "Download" in the navigation panel to go to the download page.

Q <http://www.python.org>

Don't worry about the exact number, as long as it has a 3 at the front

3 Install

Double-click the .dmg file. A window will open with several files in it, including the Python installer file "Python.mpkg". Double-click it to start the installation.



Python installer file

Python.mpkg

2 Download Python

Check which operating system your Mac has (see page 88) and click on the matching version of Python 3. You'll be prompted to save a .dmg file. Save it on your Mac desktop.

This version is for newer Macs

- Python 3.3.3 Mac OS X 64-bit... (for Mac OS X 10.6 and later)
- Python 3.3.3 Mac OS X 32-bit... (for Mac OS X 10.5 and later)

This version runs on most Macs

4 Run IDLE

During installation, click "next" at each prompt to accept the default settings. After installation ends, open the "Applications" folder on your Mac and open the "Python" folder (make sure you select Python 3, not Python 2). Double-click "IDLE" to check the installation worked.



IDLE icon

5 A Python window opens

A window like the one below should open. You can now start coding—just type into the window after the angle brackets.

```
IDLE  File  Edit  Shell  Debug  Window  Help
Untitled

Python 3.3.3 (v3.3.3:c3896275c0f6, Nov 16 2013, 23:39:35)
[GCC 4.2.1 (Apple Inc. build 5666) (dot 3)] on darwin
Type "copyright", "credits" or "license()" for more information.
>>>
```